

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

You're such a procrastinator!



Learning Outcome

Describe necessity, duty, advice, or strong disapproval in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about beliefs and opinions.
- I can report details, reasons, or results of events or actions.
- I can express willingness to do something.

Ask your partner:

- Are you a procrastinator (you leave things until the last minute to do them)?
- What are the good things about being a procrastinator?
- What are the bad things?





Let's Explore!

Arnold prepares to give his speech on procrastination. Did he remember to put his name on the **program***?

* The word "*program*" has many meanings. In this case, it is the list of speakers for the meeting.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Grace:** Hi, Arnold! Good to see you! Are you doing a Toastmaster's speech tonight? I can't remember if I saw your name on the program.
- Arnold:** Yes, I am. I want to warm up a bit. Do you want to hear a run-through of my speech?
- Grace:** Sure, I would love to hear it!
- Arnold:** I'm going to talk about the value of procrastinating.
- Grace:** Really?
- Arnold:** Yes. I'm a total believer in procrastinating. It's become a matter of principle for me.
- Grace:** I wonder if I should listen to your speech.
- Arnold:** You've been brought up to think procrastinating is bad. That's because other people have been deciding what is important for you to do, according to their own priorities. Procrastinating means deciding for yourself which tasks you can leave till the last minute. It doesn't mean not doing them, it just means waiting until you have more information to complete the task efficiently.
- Grace:** I worry about what happens if I don't have time to get everything done.
- Arnold:** Procrastinators like me believe that one of the main principles of success is doing things quickly, not perfectly. The law of diminishing returns says that after a certain point of making an effort, the amount you get back becomes smaller and smaller. In my view, trying to be perfect is very inefficient.
- Grace:** I'm not sure if this is connected to procrastinating.
- Arnold:** Yes, it is. Procrastinators are of the opinion that the task will be done faster, and therefore more efficiently, when you are closer to the deadline. You can also avoid a lot of problems caused by changing circumstances.
- Grace:** OK, I'll listen to your speech, but I'm not going to promise to become a procrastinator!



Let's Practice!

Grace talks to Arnold about tonight's speech.

Instructions: Match the statements from Column A to the ones in Column B. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. Let me know whether you need
2. I don't know whether
3. I wonder
4. I worry about what happens if I don't have
5. I'm not sure if this

COLUMN B

- a. time to get everything done.
- b. to bring my car or to go by bus.
- c. a parking space.
- d. if I should listen to your speech.
- e. is connected to procrastinating.



Let's Practice!

Arnold talks about his beliefs on procrastination.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1) believer / a / in / I'm / . / procrastinating / total

2) principles of / believe that / quickly. / Procrastinators / success is / one of / the main / doing things

3) view, trying / perfect is / In my / to be / very inefficient.

4) who don't / under pressure. / Procrastination / know how / for people / is not / to work

5) to / . / be / perfectionist / a / I / like / wouldn't





Extension Activity

Do a survey of your friends and classmates on procrastination.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Ask 10 friends and classmates if they are procrastinators. For each person, explain what this means in English.
- Ask each person to give you an example that supports their answer.
- Write down the results of your survey.
- Prepare a diagram such as a bar graph to show the results of your survey.
- Present your diagram to your class.
- In your presentation, talk about some of the examples that were mentioned.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I explain what procrastination means.

☐
☐

I ask people if they are procrastinators.

☐
☐

I prepare a diagram showing the results of the survey.

☐
☐

I present the diagram and give examples.

☐
☐


Target Words

- matter of principle** (expression): an issue that is very important
e.g. I'm a total believer in procrastinating. It's become a matter of principle for me.
- run-through** (noun): practice; trial run
e.g. Do you want to hear a run-through of my speech?
- procrastinator** (noun): a person who procrastinates (waits until the last minute to do something)
e.g. Procrastinators are of the opinion that the task will be done faster, and therefore more efficiently, when you are closer to the deadline.
- the last minute** (expression): when no more time is left
e.g. Procrastinating means deciding for yourself which tasks you can leave till the last minute.
- law of diminishing returns** (expression): the point in production when adding more factors of input results in smaller increases in output
e.g. The law of diminishing returns says that after a certain point of making an effort, the amount you get back becomes smaller and smaller.





Learning Points

The Wh-Clause: Whether and If

You can use *whether* or *if* when you want to talk about a situation where there are two possibilities or choices.

If you can ask a yes/no question, then it's usually possible to use **whether** or **if**.

*I don't know **if/whether** she's single.*

(The question here would be: Is she single?)

You usually use **whether** when you are talking about a situation with different choices.

Let's compare the following sentences.

*Let me know **whether** you need a ticket for the concert.*

(Here, the alternatives are "you need a ticket" or "you don't need a ticket". You should let me know in either case.)

*Let me know **if** you need a ticket for the concert.*

(This sentence presents a condition. Only tell me if you need a ticket. This sentence is not grammatically incorrect, it just presents a different idea from the one above.)

You use **if** more often when there is a noun clause in the sentence as the object of the verb.

*Laura wasn't sure **if** how she answered the question was wrong.*

Examples:

- *I can't remember if I saw your name on the program.*
- *I wonder if I should listen to your speech.*





Learning Points

Modals to Express Intention

You can use different modal verbs to show intention. Intention means your aim or purpose, something that you plan or want to do.

There are many times when you want to talk about or discuss things you intend to do. This could be as simple as plans for the weekend or goals you want to achieve.

You can use the following words to express these intentions.

Modal Verbs	Use
will	for intentions that you decide at the moment of speaking will (+ not) + base form of the verb <i>Example: I will make a cake today.</i>
be going to	for things that have been decided or planned before the moment of speaking form of 'be' (+ not) + going to + base form of the verb <i>Example: Julia: Eva and I are planning to study at the library. Do you want to come with us?</i> <i>Diana: Sorry, I can't. I'm going to go shopping with Carlos. (Diana had already decided to go to the mall before speaking with Julia.)</i>
would like	- this is a more polite form of 'want to' - it is often contracted to 'd in speaking would like + the infinitive of the verb <i>Example: I would like to go to the cinema to see the new James Bond movie.</i>
want to	this is the simplest way to state what you intend to do want + infinitive of the verb <i>Example: I want to buy a new dress for the party next week.</i>

You can also make questions to ask about someone's intentions.





Learning Points

Examples:

Will you **take** a vacation *this month or at the end of the year?*

How do you think you **are going to celebrate** New Year's Eve?

Would you **like to go** to the museum with me?

What do you **want to do** on the weekend?

Examples:

- *I want to warm up a bit.*
- *I'm going to talk about the value of procrastinating.*

